

Upper Room COGIC Professional Network

One Page Summary for Leadership

Prepared for: Elder Anthony Wilson, President, Men's Ministry
Organization: Upper Room Church of God in Christ
Document purpose: Overview of the professional networking platform and proposed rollout

What It Is

The Upper Room COGIC Professional Network is a church based professional directory that helps members discover one another by career, specialty, and location. It creates a trusted space where believers can share their skills, offer mentorship, provide services, and build meaningful connections within the congregation.

The Need It Addresses

Many members of our church are accomplished professionals, skilled tradespeople, entrepreneurs, and mentors. Yet there is no centralized way to find them when help, guidance, or collaboration is needed. This platform organizes that knowledge so the church can better steward the gifts already present in our community.

How It Works

1. **Members apply** through a join form on the website.
2. **Leadership reviews** each application in the admin panel.
3. **Approved profiles are published** to the public directory.
4. **Visitors search and browse** by profession, specialty, city, or keyword.
5. **Connections are made** through introduction requests rather than public exposure of private contact information.

Key Features

Feature	Benefit
Searchable member directory	Find the right person quickly
Job types and specialty categories	Easy browsing by profession
City based browsing	Connect with members in your area
Member profiles	Name, title, skills, experience, bio, links, availability
Verified member status	Builds trust within the church community
Featured members	Highlight impactful professionals
Mentorship and hiring tags	Clarify how each member is available to serve
Join application form	Controlled onboarding for new members
Admin approval workflow	Leadership maintains quality and oversight
Manual member management	Coordinators can add or update profiles directly

Ministry Value

- Supports **mentorship** for young men and emerging professionals
- Encourages **economic empowerment** through visibility and referrals

- Strengthens **fellowship** across careers and life stages
- Provides a **trusted alternative** to searching outside the church community
- Reflects **excellence, integrity, and service** in how members present their work

Leadership Oversight

The platform includes a coordinator admin panel where authorized leadership can:

- Review pending applications
- Approve or reject join requests
- Edit profile details before publishing
- Add members manually
- Remove outdated profiles
- Monitor contact and introduction requests

This ensures the directory remains accurate, respectful, and aligned with church leadership.

Proposed Rollout

Phase 1: Present to Men's Ministry leadership and identify coordinators

Phase 2: Invite an initial group of men to submit profiles

Phase 3: Review, approve, and publish founding members

Phase 4: Announce the directory to the congregation

Phase 5: Expand participation across ministries and the broader church

Request

I am requesting Elder Wilson's review, feedback, and support in introducing this platform to the Men's Ministry. A brief live demonstration can be scheduled at his convenience.

Contact

Brandon J. Fonville & Rufus Pritchett Jr.

[Your Phone Number]

[Your Email Address]